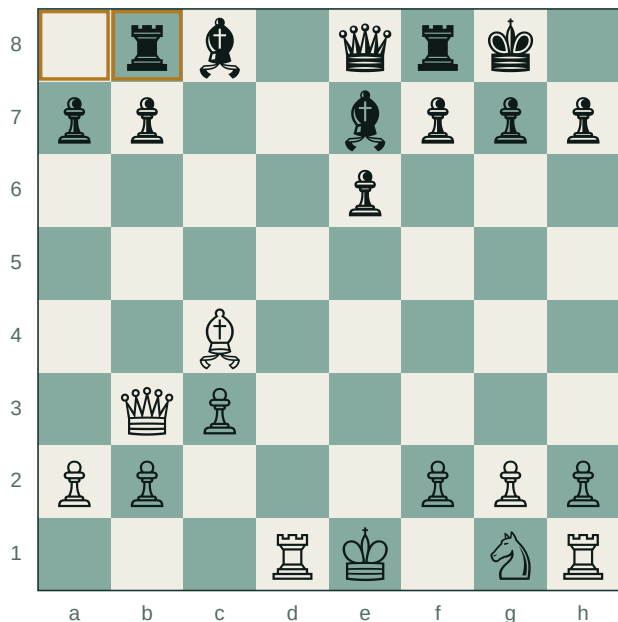


Trapping a piece: White, move 12

Trapping a piece

White to move



Previous move: 11...Rxb8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12. Bb5 Qd8 13. Rxd8

12.Bb5 The bishop moves from c4 to b5. Recorded reply: **12...Qd8**.

13.Rxd8 The rook captures the queen on d8. From d8 it attacks rook on f8 and bishop on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 31 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +9: the balance goes from +0 to +9. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

An attacked piece is not trapped if it can give check, trade itself favorably, or open an escape through a sacrifice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A trapped piece lacks safe retreat squares. Winning it usually requires restricting its routes before attacking it, or forcing it into a cage.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace every plausible escape square for the target, including captures and counterchecks. Then find the move that closes the remaining route.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b8. Check for tactical protection.